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CSD letter, May 3, 1972
By NLT-AC, NARS Date 6-24-75

China

THE WHITE HOUSE
WASHINGTON

~~SECRET~~

5 September 1945

MEMORANDUM FOR

The President

A search of all records fails to find any commitment by President Roosevelt at Cairo to arm or equip any Chinese Army in the post-war period.

From my memory of several personal conversations with the President at Cairo, I am convinced that his intention at that time in regard to the Chinese Army was to continue its training and equipment as expeditiously as possible for use in the war against Japan, up to the 100 divisions suggested by the Generalissimo.

I had no indication at any time that President Roosevelt agreed or intended to arm and equip a post-war Chinese Army.

It will undoubtedly be advantageous to the Central Government of China to have a well armed and well trained army.

American equipment is probably more efficient than captured Japanese equipment, of which latter there appears to be an ample supply available if our other Allies can be induced to agree to its delivery to the Chinese Government.

If there is statutory authority at the present time, or if statutory authority can be obtained, it should be practicable to sell to the Chinese Government a considerable amount of United States military equipment that is now available in the Orient and that will be surplus to the needs of the United States post-war army.

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